In this volume, we have explored if India is now once again adjusting its policy on China in response to China's remarkable economic and military growth over the last 10–20 years. China's rise has been a gradual process and, accordingly, India's response has also been gradual. Nonetheless, there is general agreement among the contributors to this volume that India in recent years has made some major changes in its foreign policy and is veering towards a more confrontational approach vis-à-vis China. Most notable are India's growing ties with the United States and the increased emphasis on strengthening relations with countries in India's neighbourhood in an effort to counter Chinese dominance.

Since coming into office in 2014, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has played a significant role in this recalibration of India's foreign policy. He has been instrumental in forging closer ties with the United States and in launching and implementing the "neighbourhood first" policy, being the first Prime Minister in decades to visit several of India's neighbouring countries. Still, the main driver of recent changes in India's foreign policy is China. As Muni observes in his chapter, even if India's "neighbourhood first" policy at the outset was only partially driven by the Chinese challenge, it is now dominated by it. Of the two parallel developments in India–China relations described in the respective chapters by Prasad and Engh, increased engagement and growing rivalry, the latter is of growing concern to New Delhi. In fact, India today faces an unprecedented situation vis-à-vis China, with a widening power gap, an unresolved border dispute, and a stronger Chinese footprint in its neighbourhood than ever before, and, for the first time in history, China is a hybrid land-sea power, simultaneously consolidating its position on the Eurasian continent and projecting sea power. Moreover, the geographic scope of the Sino–US rivalry expands from the Western Pacific to encompass the larger Indo-Pacific theatre.